

Figure 5: Dolphin and Nepomuk integration



Figure 6: Handling file name conflicts in Dolphin

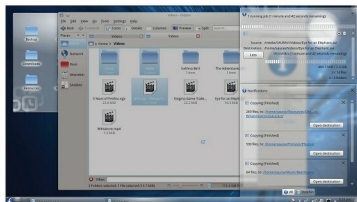


Figure 7: Notifications

the document viewer. Nautilus has gained a couple of improvements. One is a slightly enhanced Wastebasket folder. The other is better handling of conflicting file names during copy and move operations (see Figure 12). It is somewhat like Dolphin's but, as with the rest of GNOME, doesn't have as many features.

One of the better decisions the Fedora team has made is replacing Tomboy, the note-taking application, with Gnote—and removing F-Spot, the picture management application, to make way for Shotwell. Both Tomboy and F-Spot are dependent on Mono, an implementation of the Microsoft .NET framework standards. Although open source, Mono is, at best, a doubtful investment, given Microsoft's fickle moods, and its questionable fidelity to principles. Including Gnote and Shotwell instead, which are based on public code, eliminates the need to include Mono in the default

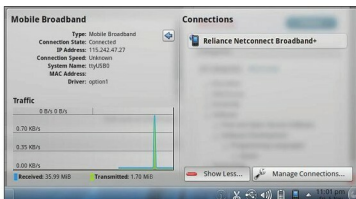


Figure 8: Network details in Network Manager

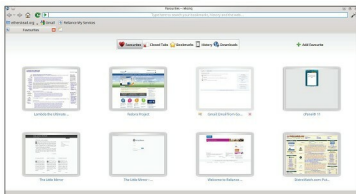


Figure 9: rekong Web browser

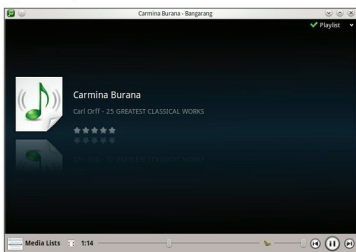


Figure 10: Bangarang playing an audio file

installation, and also gives you peace of mind—something that's becoming a rarity these days.

On the flip side, the GNOME spin, unlike the KDE one which includes Koffice, has no word processor, spreadsheet or presentation application included by default. Fedora had previously cited lack of space as a factor, but that explanation doesn't wash with me. For one, it is better to make room on the CD for these applications, instead of lesser-used features. For another, they can simply make it a DVD image. You neither have to limit yourself to 700 MB, nor do you have to pack 4 GB to create a live disc. It is easy to install OpenOffice, but the default configuration of the GNOME spin might give rise to doubts in the minds of new users.